

## ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

### PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in an international newspaper:

#### Food delivery workers

Getting food home delivered has always been one of modern life's greatest luxuries, but over the last couple of years it's gotten even better. The arrival of food delivery services like Deliveroo and Foodpanda has reshaped the whole concept of eating in. Now we can get our favourite meals delivered straight to us. It's so convenient and sounds almost too good to be true – which, it turns out, it actually is.

A published report found that many food delivery workers are paid below minimum wage and lack basic protections such as paid leave, sick pay and other benefits that regular employees enjoy. They are not paid extra for petrol or to maintain their vehicles and job security is poor as the work is irregular and so are the tips.

The food companies argue that the delivery workers aren't their employees and that most of them are casual workers. However, two-thirds of delivery workers polled said they worked a minimum of six days per week, and it was always on weekends and holidays.

The situation opens up an ethical dilemma. Millions of us regularly order home-delivered food because it's pretty affordable. But now it's clear why it's affordable – many of the workers are being exploited.

In New York City, a bill was proposed to improve the working conditions for delivery workers including a minimum per-trip payment and a measure requiring restaurants to provide bathroom access to food delivery workers.

Your group is doing a project on home food delivery. You are meeting to discuss the topic. You may want to talk about:

- the popularity of food delivery apps
- the changes of working as a food delivery worker
- how to improve the working conditions of food delivery workers
- anything else you think is important

### PART B Individual Response

1. Do you prefer food delivery or home-cooked food?
2. Do you like to order food online?
3. Would you like to work as a food delivery worker?
4. Would you be interested in working in the food industry?
5. Do food delivery apps encourage unhealthy eating habits?
6. How can food delivery be more environmentally-friendly?
7. Do you think home food delivery will continue to be popular?
8. Do you think technology will replace food delivery workers in the future?